

SBI CLERK 2026

COMPLETE TOPPER'S GUIDE

Everything You Need to Score 150+/200 and Get Top Rank

Exam	SBI Junior Associate (Customer Support & Sales) 2026
Advertisement No.	CRPD/CR/2026-27/17
Vacancies	9,766 across India
Prelims Date	26, 27 Sep and 3 Oct 2026
Mains Date	23 Nov 2026
Admit Card	Available ~20 Sep 2026 on sbi.bank.in
Selection	Prelims (qualifying) -> Mains (final merit) -> LPT -> Document Verification
Your Target	75+ in Prelims 150+ in Mains Top rank in Maharashtra OBC
Your Advantage	B.E. CS + eScan = Computer Aptitude 20/20 FREE

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Chapter 1: Exam Pattern, Scoring & OBC Cutoffs

SBI Clerk 2026

PRELIMS PATTERN — Qualifying (score NOT counted in merit)

Section	Questions	Marks	Time	Negative	Target
English Language	30	30	20 min LOCKED	-0.25	20+
Numerical Ability	35	35	20 min LOCKED	-0.25	24+
Reasoning Ability	35	35	20 min LOCKED	-0.25	26+
TOTAL	100	100	60 min	-0.25/wrong	75+ to be safe

PRELIMS CRITICAL: Sections are time-LOCKED. You CANNOT go back to previous section or jump ahead. Manage every 20 minutes strictly within that section. Leaving a section early wastes marks.

MAINS PATTERN — Final Merit (ONLY Mains score determines selection)

Section	Q	Marks	Time	Neg.	Topper target	Your B.E. advantage
General/Financial Awareness	50	50	35 min	-0.25	38-42	Study daily — biggest differentiator
General English	40	40	35 min	-0.25	30-34	Grammar rules below
Quantitative Aptitude + DI	50	50	45 min	-0.25	32-38	Formulas + DI strategy below
Reasoning + Computer Aptitude	50	60	45 min	-0.25	50-55	Computer 20/20 FREE for you
TOTAL	190	200	160 min	-0.25	150-169	Top rank in Maharashtra OBC

OBC-NCL CUTOFFS — Maharashtra (Historical)

Stage	OBC-NCL cutoff	General cutoff	Your safe target	What it means
Prelims (Maharashtra)	58-65 / 100	64-70 / 100	75+ / 100	10+ buffer above cutoff
Mains (Maharashtra)	68-76 / 200	76-80 / 200	150+ / 200	Top 2% — guaranteed best posting

Your OBC-NCL certificates (caste certificate + validity certificate + NCL certificate) cover all reservation benefits at every stage. Keep all three original documents safe until document verification.

How to reach 150+ in Mains

General/Financial Awareness	38 / 50
General English	31 / 40
Quantitative Aptitude + DI	33 / 50
Reasoning + Computer Aptitude	50 / 60
TOTAL TARGET	152 / 200

KEY INSIGHT: OBC cutoff in Mains is ~70/200. Even scoring 100/200 gets you selected. But scoring 150+ puts you in TOP 2% — meaning you get first choice of posting (Mumbai), first choice of branch, and best career start. The extra effort to go from 100 to 150 is purely in GK (daily 15-min habit) and Computer Aptitude (already free for you as B.E. CS).

Chapter 2: Reasoning Ability — Complete Notes & Shortcuts

35 marks Prelims | 60 marks Mains

TOPIC-WISE MARKS & PRIORITY

Topic	Questions	Marks	Priority
Puzzles & Seating Arrangement	15-20 Q	15-20 marks	HIGHEST — master 3 types
Syllogism	4-5 Q	4-5 marks	HIGH — always attempt
Inequality	4-5 Q	4-5 marks	HIGH — 20 sec per Q
Input-Output	5 Q (Mains)	5 marks	HIGH — find pattern in Step 1
Coding-Decoding	4-5 Q	4-5 marks	MEDIUM — pattern in 30 sec
Blood Relations	3-5 Q	3-5 marks	MEDIUM — draw family tree
Direction Sense	3-5 Q	3-5 marks	MEDIUM — draw compass
Logical Reasoning (Mains)	5-8 Q	5-8 marks	MEDIUM — Statement-Conclusion
Alphanumeric Series	3-5 Q	3-5 marks	EASY — 30 sec each

PUZZLE SOLVING — 5-STEP UNIVERSAL METHOD

Step 1 — Read ALL clues first (30 sec, do NOT draw yet)

Read every clue once completely before picking up your pen. Many candidates start drawing after Clue 1 and have to erase everything. Understanding the full picture first saves total time.

Step 2 — Identify and place DEFINITE clues first

Look for clues that give exact positions: "A sits at position 3" or "G is at the topmost floor." These are your anchors. Place all definite positions before touching relative clues.

Step 3 — Use relative clues to extend from anchors

"B is 2nd to the right of A." If A=3, then B=5. Always extend FROM what you already know. Never try to place two unknowns relative to each other without at least one anchor.

Step 4 — Use elimination for remaining positions

If 6 of 7 positions are filled, the last person goes into the only remaining slot. Eliminate wrong options systematically — do not guess.

Step 5 — VERIFY one clue before answering

After completing the arrangement, pick the trickiest clue and check your arrangement satisfies it. If not, you made an error somewhere. Fix before answering all 5 questions.

SEATING ARRANGEMENT — CRITICAL DIRECTION RULES

LINEAR (facing North): Your LEFT = West direction. Your RIGHT = East direction. "3rd to the right" = +3 positions when numbered left to right.

LINEAR 2-ROW FACING: "A faces B" means A and B are in opposite rows at the SAME column position. "A is behind B" means same column, A faces away from B.

CIRCULAR (facing CENTRE): Your LEFT = CLOCKWISE direction on the circle. Your RIGHT = ANTI-CLOCKWISE. "Immediate right of A" = the person just anti-clockwise from A.

CIRCULAR (facing OUTSIDE): ALL directions REVERSE. Left = anti-clockwise. Right = clockwise.

OPPOSITE in N-person circle: Always N/2 seats apart. In 6-person: 3 seats apart. In 8-person: 4 seats apart.

SYLLOGISM — COMPLETE RULES

Statement(s)	=>	Valid Conclusion
All A are B + All B are C	=>	All A are C (universal positive chain)
All A are B + Some B are C	=>	Some A are C (CANNOT be concluded — very common trap)
Some A are B + All B are C	=>	Some A are C (particular + universal gives particular)
No A is B + All C are A	=>	No C is B (universal negative transfers)
Some A are B + No B is C	=>	Some A are not C
All A are B (conversion)	=>	Some B are A (valid) All B are A (INVALID)
No A is B (conversion)	=>	No B is A (valid)
Some A are B (conversion)	=>	Some B are A (valid)
Some A are not B (conversion)	=>	Some B are not A (INVALID — classic trap)

EITHER/OR rule: When Conclusion I and Conclusion II are COMPLEMENTARY (one positive, one negative about the same pair) AND neither follows individually — mark "Either I or II follows."

INEQUALITY — 10-SECOND METHOD

CHAIN RULE: $A > B \geq C$ means $A > C$. The weakest link determines the final relationship.

Signs in chain	Final result	Example
$>$ and $>$	$>$	$A > B > C \Rightarrow A > C$
$\geq$ and $>$	$>$	$A \geq B > C \Rightarrow A > C$
$>$ and $\geq$	$>$	$A > B \geq C \Rightarrow A > C$
$\geq$ and $\geq$	$\geq$	$A \geq B \geq C \Rightarrow A \geq C$
$>$ and $<$	BREAK — Cannot determine	$A > B$ and $C < B \Rightarrow A$ vs C unknown
$>$ and $=$	$>$	$A > B = C \Rightarrow A > C$
$=$ and $>$	$>$	$A = B > C \Rightarrow A > C$

CHAIN BREAK: When the middle variable appears on the SAME SIDE of both inequalities (e.g. $A > B$ and $C > B$ — both greater than B), there is NO definite conclusion between A and C.

DIRECTION SENSE — STANDARD COMPASS + DISTANCE RULES

COMPASS: N is up, S is down, E is right, W is left. Always draw this before solving.

Action	Result
Walk N then turn right	Now facing East
Walk N then turn left	Now facing West
Walk S then turn right	Now facing West
Walk S then turn left	Now facing East
Clockwise 90 deg from N	Now facing East
Clockwise 90 deg from E	Now facing South
Anti-clockwise 90 deg from N	Now facing West
Pythagoras: East x, North y	Straight-line distance = $\sqrt{x^2 + y^2}$

CODING-DECODING — PATTERN IDENTIFICATION

LETTER SHIFT: Find how much each letter is shifted. B->D means +2. Apply same shift to all letters.

REVERSE CODING: MANGO coded as OGNAM means the word is simply reversed.

POSITIONAL: A=1,B=2,...Z=26. Code = sum of positions. RED=18+5+4=27.

SENTENCE CODING: Find the common word between two sentences — it shares the same code. Decode by elimination.

NEW PATTERN: Code is given as symbols/numbers for full sentences. Compare pairs to isolate individual word codes.

Chapter 3: Quantitative Aptitude — All Formulas & Tricks

35 marks Prelims | 50 marks Mains

MUST-MEMORISE TABLES

Squares (1-25)

$1^2=1$	$2^2=4$	$3^2=9$	$4^2=16$	$5^2=25$
$6^2=36$	$7^2=49$	$8^2=64$	$9^2=81$	$10^2=100$
$11^2=121$	$12^2=144$	$13^2=169$	$14^2=196$	$15^2=225$
$16^2=256$	$17^2=289$	$18^2=324$	$19^2=361$	$20^2=400$
$21^2=441$	$22^2=484$	$23^2=529$	$24^2=576$	$25^2=625$

Cubes (1-15)

$1^3=1$	$2^3=8$	$3^3=27$	$4^3=64$	$5^3=125$
$6^3=216$	$7^3=343$	$8^3=512$	$9^3=729$	$10^3=1000$
$11^3=1331$	$12^3=1728$	$13^3=2197$	$14^3=2744$	$15^3=3375$

Fraction to Percentage Conversions

$1/2=50\%$	$1/3=33.33\%$	$1/4=25\%$	$1/5=20\%$	$1/6=16.67\%$
$1/7=14.28\%$	$1/8=12.5\%$	$1/9=11.11\%$	$1/10=10\%$	$1/11=9.09\%$
$1/12=8.33\%$	$2/3=66.67\%$	$3/4=75\%$	$2/5=40\%$	$3/5=60\%$
$4/5=80\%$	$5/6=83.33\%$	$3/8=37.5\%$	$5/8=62.5\%$	$7/8=87.5\%$

ALL FORMULAS — SECTION WISE

PERCENTAGE

x% of y	$y \times x / 100$
A is what % of B	$(A/B) \times 100$
% increase	$(\text{New} - \text{Old}) / \text{Old} \times 100$
% decrease	$(\text{Old} - \text{New}) / \text{Old} \times 100$
Successive % change: a% then b%	$\text{Net} = a + b + (a \times b)/100$
Price up x%, consumption reduce to keep expenditure same	$\text{Reduce by } x/(100+x) \times 100 \%$

PROFIT, LOSS & DISCOUNT

Profit	$\text{SP} - \text{CP}$
Loss	$\text{CP} - \text{SP}$
Profit %	$(\text{Profit} / \text{CP}) \times 100$
SP (given CP and P%)	$\text{CP} \times (100 + \text{P}\%) / 100$
CP (given SP and P%)	$\text{SP} \times 100 / (100 + \text{P}\%)$
SP (given CP and Loss%)	$\text{CP} \times (100 - \text{Loss}\%) / 100$
Discount %	$(\text{Discount} / \text{MP}) \times 100$
SP after discount	$\text{MP} \times (100 - \text{D}\%) / 100$

Successive discounts d1 and d2	Net discount = $d1 + d2 - (d1 \times d2)/100$
Profit when SP of m = CP of n	Profit% = $(n-m)/m \times 100$

SIMPLE & COMPOUND INTEREST

Simple Interest	SI = $P \times R \times T / 100$
Amount (SI)	A = $P + SI = P(1 + RT/100)$
Compound Interest	CI = $P[(1 + R/100)^T - 1]$
Amount (CI)	A = $P(1 + R/100)^T$
CI - SI for 2 years	$P \times (R/100)^2$
Rate to double at SI (rule of 72)	72 / R years (approximate)
Exact doubling time at SI	100/R years
Tripling time at SI	200/R years

TIME, SPEED & DISTANCE

Basic formula	Speed = Distance / Time
Average speed (equal distances)	$2ab / (a+b)$ km/h
Relative speed (same direction)	$v1 - v2$
Relative speed (opposite direction)	$v1 + v2$
Train crosses pole	Speed = Train length / Time
Train crosses platform	Speed = (Train length + Platform length) / Time
Two trains (opposite direction)	Time = $(L1 + L2) / (v1 + v2)$
km/h to m/s	Multiply by 5/18
m/s to km/h	Multiply by 18/5
Upstream speed	Boat speed - Stream speed
Downstream speed	Boat speed + Stream speed
Speed of stream	$(\text{Downstream} - \text{Upstream}) / 2$
Speed of boat in still water	$(\text{Downstream} + \text{Upstream}) / 2$

TIME & WORK

A completes in n days => A's 1-day work	1/n
A and B together	$ab / (a+b)$ days
A, B, C together	$1 / (1/a + 1/b + 1/c)$ days
Pipe fill in a hrs, drain in b hrs (b>a)	Net fill = $ab/(b-a)$ hours
M men in D days = M1 men in D1 days (equal work)	MD = M1D1
Efficiency is inversely proportional to time	E x T = constant (total work)

RATIO, PROPORTION & ALLIGATION

Alligation rule	Qty1 : Qty2 = (Dearer - Mean) : (Mean - Cheaper)
Mixture: remove v litres from V litres n times	Final conc = $C \times (1 - v/V)^n$
Partnership profit ratio (same time)	Ratio = Investment1 : Investment2
Partnership (different time)	Ratio = $P1 \times T1 : P2 \times T2$

AVERAGE, PERMUTATION & PROBABILITY

Average	Sum of all values / Count of values
Weighted average	$(w_1 \times x_1 + w_2 \times x_2 + \dots) / (w_1 + w_2 + \dots)$
Permutation (arrangement)	$nPr = n! / (n-r)!$
Combination (selection)	$nCr = n! / [r! \times (n-r)!]$
Circular arrangement	$(n-1)!$ ways
Probability	$P(E) = \text{Favourable outcomes} / \text{Total outcomes}$
Complementary probability	$P(E) + P(E') = 1$

SPEED MATH TRICKS

[Multiply any 2-digit number by 11] Keep first digit | add both digits in middle | keep last digit. Example: $54 \times 11 = 5|9|4 = 594$. If middle sum ≥ 10 , carry over: $67 \times 11 = 6|(6+7)|7 = 6|13|7 = 737$.

[Square numbers ending in 5] $n5^2 = n \times (n+1)$ followed by 25. Example: $35^2 = 3 \times 4 = 12$, append 25 = 1225. $75^2 = 7 \times 8 = 56$, append 25 = 5625.

[Multiply numbers near 100] $(100-a)(100-b) = 100[(100-a)+(100-b)-100] + ab$. Example: 97×96 : cross subtract $97-4=93$, multiply differences $3 \times 4 = 12$, Answer = 9312.

[Divide by 5] Multiply by 2, then divide by 10. Example: $480/5 = 960/10 = 96$.

[Divide by 25] Multiply by 4, then divide by 100. Example: $1750/25 = 7000/100 = 70$.

[Find 15% quickly] $10\% + 5\%$ (half of 10%). Example: 15% of 840 = $84 + 42 = 126$.

[Approximation in DI] Round to nearest clean number. Options are usually spread wide enough. $399.8 \times 20.1 / 4.98$ approx = $400 \times 20 / 5 = 1600$.

[Quadratic factorisation shortcut] For $x^2+bx+c=0$, find two numbers that MULTIPLY to c and ADD to b. Example: $x^2-5x+6=0$: numbers that multiply to 6 and add to -5 are -2 and -3. So $x=2,3$.

DI STRATEGY — How to Solve Each Type in Minimum Time

DI Type	Time	Strategy
Table DI (fastest)	4-5 min	Read all 5 Q first. Extract only needed cells. Use approximation. Attempt first.
Bar Chart	5-6 min	Visual comparison is fast. Approximation works well. Attempt second.
Line Graph	6-7 min	Trend and ratio questions. Approximate where possible. Attempt third.
Pie Chart	6-8 min	Convert % to absolute values ONCE and reuse. For ratio Q, divide percentages directly without converting. Attempt fourth.
Casest (paragraph)	8-12 min	Read paragraph once. Build a mini-table from the data before answering any question. Attempt last.

Chapter 4: English Language — Grammar Rules & Vocabulary

30 marks Prelims | 40 marks Mains

OPTIMAL QUESTION ORDER IN EXAM

For Mains (35 min): Fill in the Blanks (4 min) -> Error Detection (8 min) -> Cloze Test (8 min) -> Para Jumbles (5 min) -> Reading Comprehension (10 min). For Prelims (20 min): same order but faster.

In RC: Read ALL questions first (45 sec), then scan passage for answers. NEVER read full passage first — saves 3-4 minutes per passage.

THE 10 GRAMMAR RULES COVERING 90% OF ERROR DETECTION QUESTIONS

1. Subject-Verb Agreement

Singular subjects take singular verbs: The team **IS** playing (not ARE).

Each / Every / Either / Neither / Anyone / Someone = SINGULAR: "Each of the students **HAS** submitted."

"The number of" = singular: "The number of errors **IS** high."

"A number of" = plural: "A number of people **ARE** waiting."

Collective nouns (committee, jury, team, crowd) = singular in formal context.

2. Tense Errors

"Since" needs present perfect: "I **HAVE** worked here since 2020" (not "I work").

"For" with duration needs present perfect: "I **HAVE** worked here for 5 years."

"Yesterday/last week/in 2019" = simple past, never present perfect.

"As soon as + simple past, simple past" — do not use "had" unnecessarily.

"Scarcely/Hardly...WHEN" (not "than"). "No sooner...THAN" (not "when").

3. Preposition Errors

"Despite" NEVER takes "of": "Despite his efforts" (not "Despite of").

"Married **TO**" not "married with".

"Looking forward **TO** + gerund (-ing)": "looking forward to **MEETING**" (not "to meet").

"Differ **FROM**" not "differ than".

"Immune **TO**" not "immune from".

"Aim **AT**" not "aim for" when followed by a gerund.

4. Pronoun Errors

"Each/Neither/Neither" = singular pronoun: "Each student must submit **HIS/HER** assignment" (not "their").

"One of those who" = plural verb: "one of the best books that **HAVE** been written."

Relative pronoun: use "who/whom" for persons, "which/that" for things.

"Between" for two things, "Among" for more than two.

5. Article Errors

"A" before consonant sounds, "An" before vowel sounds: "an honest man" (h is silent).

Superlatives need "the": "She is **THE** best student."

Names of countries/languages/sports do not take articles: "He plays cricket" (not "the cricket").

"The" before unique things: the sun, the moon, the president.

PARA JUMBLES — SYSTEMATIC METHOD

Step 1: Find the OPENER — introduces the topic, no pronoun reference to previous idea, no connector word at start.

Step 2: Find the CONCLUSION — summarises, uses words like "thus", "therefore", "in summary", "hence", "so".

Step 3: Find CONNECTORS in middle sentences — "however", "therefore", "as a result", "for example", "moreover", "furthermore", "despite this".

Step 4: Link pairs — if sentence B says "this" or "these", the previous sentence must define what "this" refers to.

Common trap: Sentences starting with "but/however/although" are NEVER openers.

VOCABULARY — HIGH-FREQUENCY WORDS IN BANKING EXAMS

Word	Meaning	Antonym
Pragmatic	Practical, realistic	Impractical, idealistic
Lucid	Clear, easy to understand	Ambiguous, confusing
Ephemeral	Short-lived, transient	Permanent, eternal
Verbose	Using too many words	Concise, brief
Affluent	Wealthy, prosperous	Impoverished, poor
Dormant	Inactive, sleeping	Active, functioning
Prodigal	Wastefully extravagant	Thrifty, frugal
Credulous	Too ready to believe	Sceptical, suspicious
Resilient	Able to recover quickly	Fragile, weak
Transparent	Open, clear, easy to see through	Opaque, secretive
Prudent	Wise and careful	Reckless, imprudent
Mandate	Official order or requirement	Optional, voluntary
Stringent	Strict and precise	Lenient, relaxed
Volatile	Liable to change rapidly	Stable, steady
Liquidate	Convert assets to cash / close down	Accumulate, invest
Solvent	Able to pay debts	Insolvent, bankrupt
Collateral	Security for a loan	—
Nominal	In name only / very small	Substantial, real
Escalate	Increase rapidly	Decrease, de-escalate
Viable	Capable of working successfully	Unviable, impossible

Chapter 5: Computer Aptitude — Complete Notes

20 marks FREE for B.E.
CS | Score 20/20

WHY THIS IS FREE FOR YOU

You have a B.E. in Computer Engineering (Mumbai University, 2020) and work at eScan MicroWorld — an antivirus and cybersecurity company. Every single topic in Computer Aptitude (hardware, OS, networking, security, MS Office) is your professional and academic background. Average candidates spend weeks on this section. You need only 30 minutes of review.

Strategy: In Mains, attempt Computer Aptitude FIRST — all 10 questions in 8 minutes. This locks in 18-20 marks immediately, calms your nerves, and gives you more time for other sections.

COMPLETE COMPUTER APTITUDE NOTES

HARDWARE

CPU	Central Processing Unit — brain of computer. Contains ALU (arithmetic/logic) + Control Unit + Registers.
RAM	Random Access Memory — volatile, temporary, fast. Data lost when power off.
ROM	Read Only Memory — non-volatile, permanent. Retains data without power.
HDD vs SSD	HDD = Hard Disk Drive (magnetic, moving parts, slower). SSD = Solid State Drive (flash memory, no moving parts, faster).
Input devices	Keyboard, Mouse, Scanner, Barcode Reader, OCR, OMR, MICR, Webcam, Microphone, Joystick.
Output devices	Monitor, Printer (Laser/Inkjet/Dot matrix), Projector, Speaker, Plotter.
Storage units	1 Byte=8 bits 1 KB=1024 Bytes 1 MB=1024 KB 1 GB=1024 MB 1 TB=1024 GB

OPERATING SYSTEM

Types of OS	Batch OS Time-sharing Real-time Multi-tasking Multi-user Distributed Embedded
Linux	Open-source OS. Kernel-based. Command line interface. Your daily work at eScan.
Windows	GUI-based OS by Microsoft. Most common desktop OS.
Android/iOS	Mobile operating systems — Android (Linux-based, Google), iOS (Apple).
File systems	NTFS (Windows) FAT32 (older/USB) ext4 (Linux) APFS (Mac)
Process vs Thread	Process = independent program. Thread = unit within a process. Multi-threading = concurrent execution.

NUMBER SYSTEMS

Binary (base 2)	Digits: 0,1. Computer's native language. $1011(\text{binary}) = 1 \times 8 + 0 \times 4 + 1 \times 2 + 1 \times 1 = 11(\text{decimal})$
Decimal (base 10)	Digits: 0-9. Human system. Convert from binary: sum positional values.
Hexadecimal (base 16)	Digits: 0-9, A=10, B=11, C=12, D=13, E=14, F=15. $FF = 15 \times 16 + 15 = 255(\text{decimal})$.
Octal (base 8)	Digits: 0-7. Conversion: group binary digits in sets of 3.
Key conversions	Decimal to Binary: repeatedly divide by 2, read remainders upward. $13 = 8 + 4 + 1 = 1101(\text{binary})$.

MS OFFICE — KEYBOARD SHORTCUTS

Ctrl+C/V/X	Copy / Paste / Cut
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Ctrl+Z/Y	Undo / Redo
Ctrl+A	Select All
Ctrl+B/I/U	Bold / Italic / Underline
Ctrl+S/P/N/O	Save / Print / New / Open
Ctrl+F/H	Find / Find and Replace
Ctrl+Home/End	Go to document start / end
F1/F5/F7/F12	Help / Go To / Spelling Check / Save As
Alt+F4	Close current application
Windows+D	Show desktop
Print Screen	Take screenshot
Excel: =SUM()	=SUM(A1:A10) — adds range
Excel: =AVERAGE()	=AVERAGE(B1:B5) — calculates mean
Excel: =IF()	=IF(A1>100,"Pass","Fail") — conditional
Excel: =VLOOKUP()	=VLOOKUP(value, table, col, 0) — vertical lookup
Excel: \$A\$1	Absolute reference — does not change when formula is copied

NETWORKING

LAN	Local Area Network — limited area (home/office)
WAN	Wide Area Network — large geographic area (internet)
MAN	Metropolitan Area Network — city-wide
IP Address	Unique identifier for device on network. IPv4=32-bit. IPv6=128-bit.
DNS	Domain Name System — translates domain names to IP addresses
HTTP/HTTPS	HyperText Transfer Protocol. HTTPS = HTTP + SSL/TLS encryption (secure)
FTP	File Transfer Protocol — transfers files between computers
SMTP	Simple Mail Transfer Protocol — SENDS email
POP3/IMAP	Receive email. POP3 downloads and removes from server. IMAP keeps on server.
Router	Connects different networks, routes data packets
Switch	Connects devices within same network (LAN)
Modem	Modulates/demodulates signals — connects to internet via ISP

CYBERSECURITY (Your eScan Expertise)

Virus	Attaches to files. Spreads when infected file is run. Damages data.
Worm	Self-replicates and spreads across network WITHOUT user action.
Trojan Horse	Disguises as legitimate software but carries malicious code.
Ransomware	Encrypts victim's files and demands payment for decryption key.
Spyware	Secretly monitors user activity and steals credentials/data.
Adware	Displays unwanted advertisements. Often bundled with free software.
Firewall	Network security tool that monitors/filters traffic. Blocks unauthorized access.
Antivirus	Software that detects, blocks, and removes malware. Your work at eScan!
Phishing	Fake emails/websites to steal credentials. Most common cybercrime.
Vishing/Smishing	Phishing via Voice call (Vishing) or SMS (Smishing).
Two-Factor Auth (2FA)	Two layers of verification: password + OTP. Much more secure.
Encryption	Converting data to unreadable code. HTTPS uses SSL/TLS encryption.

VPN	Virtual Private Network — encrypts internet connection, hides IP address.
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DATABASE

DBMS	Database Management System — organises and manages data.
RDBMS	Relational DBMS — stores data in tables with rows and columns. MySQL, Oracle.
Primary Key	Unique identifier for each row in a table. Cannot be NULL.
Foreign Key	Links one table to another table's primary key.
SQL — SELECT	SELECT * FROM table WHERE condition — retrieves data
SQL — INSERT	INSERT INTO table (col) VALUES (val) — adds new row
SQL — UPDATE	UPDATE table SET col=val WHERE condition — modifies data
SQL — DELETE	DELETE FROM table WHERE condition — removes rows

Chapter 6: Banking GK — Complete Reference Capsule

50 marks Mains | Read
15 min daily | Biggest
differentiator

RBI KEY RATES (August 2026) — MEMORISE EXACTLY

Rate / Person	Value	What it means
Repo Rate	5.25%	Rate at which RBI lends to commercial banks. Last reduced Dec 2025.
Reverse Repo Rate	3.35%	Rate at which RBI borrows from commercial banks.
CRR (Cash Reserve Ratio)	3.00%	% of NDTL that banks must keep as cash WITH RBI.
SLR (Statutory Liquidity Ratio)	18.00%	% of NDTL that banks must hold as liquid assets (gold, Govt securities).
SDF (Standing Deposit Facility)	5.00%	Floor of interest rate corridor. Repo Rate minus 25 basis points.
MSF (Marginal Standing Facility)	5.50%	Ceiling of interest rate corridor. Repo Rate plus 25 basis points.
Bank Rate	5.50%	Same as MSF rate. Penalty rate for shortfall in SLR.
Policy Stance	Neutral	MPC stance as of June 2026.
RBI Governor	Sanjay Malhotra	Appointed December 2024. 26th RBI Governor. HQ: Mumbai.

MEMORY TRICK: "ROBIN" = Repo 5.25 | rOntrary (reverse repo) 3.35 | Bank rate 5.50 | Insertion SDF 5.00 | Net CRR 3.00

SBI KEY FACTS

Item	Fact
SBI Chairman	C.S. Setty (Challa Sreenivasulu Setty) — since August 2024
SBI Headquarters	State Bank Bhavan, Nariman Point, Mumbai
SBI Founded	1 July 1955 (under SBI Act 1955). Earlier: Imperial Bank of India.
SBI Tagline	"With you all the way"
SBI SWIFT Code	SBININBB
Government stake in SBI	57.5%+ (Government of India is majority owner)
SBI Branches	22,000+ across India
SBI ATMs	70,000+ (largest ATM network in India)
SBI Digital Platform	YONO — You Only Need One (all-in-one banking + shopping app)
SBI Subsidiaries	SBI Life Insurance SBI Cards SBI Mutual Fund SBI General Insurance SBI Capital Markets
YOUR Post after selection	Junior Associate (Customer Support & Sales) — Clerical cadre
Promotion path	Clerk -> JMGS-I Officer (2-3 yrs via internal exam) -> MMGS-II -> MMGS-III -> SMGS-IV

GOVERNMENT SCHEMES — KEY NUMBERS (asked directly)

PM Jan Dhan Yojana (PMJDY)

Zero balance savings account | RuPay debit card | Rs.2 lakh accident insurance | Rs.30,000 life cover | Rs.10,000 overdraft facility | All citizens

PM Suraksha Bima Yojana (PMSBY)

Rs.20/year premium | Rs.2 lakh (death/total disability) | Rs.1 lakh (partial disability) | Age 18-70 years | Auto-debit from savings account

PM Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana (PMJJBY)

Rs.436/year premium | Rs.2 lakh life cover (death from any cause) | Age 18-55 years | Annual renewal | Savings bank account needed

Atal Pension Yojana (APY)

Age 18-40 years | Pension Rs.1,000 to Rs.5,000/month at age 60 | NPS-based | Govt co-contributes for eligible subscribers

PM MUDRA Yojana

Shishu: up to Rs.50,000 | Kishor: Rs.50,000 to Rs.5 lakh | Tarun: Rs.5 lakh to Rs.10 lakh | Tarun Plus: Rs.10 lakh to Rs.20 lakh | For non-corporate small businesses

Stand Up India

Rs.10 lakh to Rs.1 crore loans | For SC/ST and Women entrepreneurs only | Greenfield enterprises only | Bank-based scheme

PM Kisan Samman Nidhi

Rs.6,000/year in 3 equal instalments of Rs.2,000 each | Direct to Aadhaar-linked bank accounts | Small and marginal farmers

Sukanya Samriddhi Yojana (SSY)

For girl child up to 10 years | ~8.2% interest (highest small savings rate) | Matures at 21 years of girl | Min Rs.250/year | Tax benefit under Sec 80C

Digital India

Vision: Digital infrastructure + Digital services + Digital literacy | DigiLocker | UPI | e-Governance portals | Common Services Centres

PM Vaya Vandana Yojana

For senior citizens (60+ years) | Guaranteed pension | LIC managed | 10-year policy term

BANKING TERMS GLOSSARY

Term	Full explanation
NPA	Non-Performing Asset — loan where interest/principal unpaid for 90+ days.
GNPA vs NNPA	Gross NPA = total NPAs before provisions. Net NPA = GNPA minus provisions.
Sub-standard / Doubtful / Loss	NPA categories: Sub-standard (<12 months) Doubtful (12-36 months) Loss (>36 months).
CRAR	Capital to Risk-weighted Assets Ratio. Minimum 9% for Indian banks (Basel III). Measures bank capital adequacy.
CASA Ratio	Proportion of Current Account + Savings Account deposits to total deposits. Higher CASA = lower cost of funds.

Term	Full explanation
KYC	Know Your Customer — mandatory identity and address verification for all bank accounts.
AML	Anti-Money Laundering — measures to prevent conversion of illegally obtained money.
PMLA 2002	Prevention of Money Laundering Act — primary AML legislation in India.
RTGS	Real Time Gross Settlement — instant large-value transfers. Min Rs.2 lakh. No maximum. 24x7.
NEFT	National Electronic Funds Transfer — 24x7, half-hourly batches. No minimum or maximum limit.
IMPS	Immediate Payment Service — instant 24x7 transfers. Max Rs.5 lakh per transaction.
UPI	Unified Payments Interface — real-time mobile payments. Max Rs.1 lakh standard. Operated by NPCI.
RuPay	India's domestic card payment network developed by NPCI. Alternative to Visa/Mastercard.
IFSC Code	11-character code: first 4 = bank code, 5th = 0 (reserved), last 6 = branch code.
SARFAESI Act 2002	Allows banks to auction mortgaged property to recover NPAs WITHOUT court order.
FEMA 1999	Foreign Exchange Management Act — governs forex transactions in India. Replaced FERA.
Basel III in India	International banking norms. Implemented from April 2013. Min CRAR = 9% (India), 8% (global).
Priority Sector Lending	Banks must lend 40% of ANBC to priority sectors (Agriculture 18%, MSME, etc.).
CIBIL Score	Credit score ranging from 300 to 900. Score of 750+ considered good for loans.
NABARD	National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development. Apex institution for agricultural/rural credit. HQ: Mumbai.
SIDBI	Small Industries Development Bank of India. Focuses on MSME financing. HQ: Lucknow.
EXIM Bank	Export-Import Bank of India. Finances India's international trade and investment. HQ: Mumbai.
NHB	National Housing Bank. Regulates Housing Finance Companies (HFCs). HQ: New Delhi.
SEBI	Securities and Exchange Board of India. Regulates stock markets. HQ: Mumbai. Est. 1992.
IRDAI	Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India. HQ: Hyderabad.
PFRDA	Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority. Regulates NPS. HQ: New Delhi.
NPCI	National Payments Corporation of India. Operates UPI, RuPay, NEFT, IMPS, FASTag, NACH.
BSE/NSE	Bombay Stock Exchange (est. 1875, oldest in Asia) National Stock Exchange (est. 1992). Both HQ: Mumbai.
IMF	International Monetary Fund. HQ: Washington D.C. Provides international financial assistance.
World Bank	HQ: Washington D.C. President: Ajay Banga (Indian-American). Funds development projects.
ADB	Asian Development Bank. HQ: Manila, Philippines. Funds Asian development.

Bank/Inst.	HQ	Bank/Inst.	HQ	Bank/Inst.	HQ
RBI	Mumbai	NABARD	Mumbai	SEBI	Mumbai
SBI	Mumbai	SIDBI	Lucknow	IRDAI	Hyderabad
Bank of Baroda	Vadodara	EXIM Bank	Mumbai	PFRDA	New Delhi
PNB	New Delhi	NHB	New Delhi	NPCI	Mumbai
Canara Bank	Bengaluru	BSE	Mumbai	NSE	Mumbai
Union Bank	Mumbai	IMF	Washington D.C.	World Bank	Washington D.C.
Bank of India	Mumbai	ADB	Manila	NDB (BRICS)	Shanghai
Indian Bank	Chennai	HDFC Bank	Mumbai	ICICI Bank	Mumbai
IOB	Chennai	Axis Bank	Mumbai	Kotak Bank	Mumbai
Central Bank	Mumbai	Bank of Mah.	Pune	UCO Bank	Kolkata

Chapter 7: Verified Practice Questions

All answers computed
and verified

QR1. Statements: All cats are dogs. All dogs are animals. Conclusions: I. All cats are animals. II. Some animals are cats.

- (a) Only I
- (b) Only II
- (c) Both I and II
- (d) Neither
- (e) Either I or II

Answer: (c) Both I and II

Explanation: All cats $\rightarrow$ dogs + All dogs $\rightarrow$ animals $\Rightarrow$ All cats $\rightarrow$ animals (I). Conversion gives: Some animals are cats (II). Both follow.

QR2. $A > B \geq C = D < E$. Which is definitely true?

- (a) $A > D$
- (b) $E > A$
- (c) $A = C$
- (d) $D > E$
- (e) $B = D$

Answer: (a) $A > D$

Explanation: Chain: $A > B \geq C = D \Rightarrow A > D$. $E > D$ but E vs A cannot be determined. Only (a) is definitely true.

QR3. Pointing to a photo, Raj says "Her mother is the only daughter of my mother." How is the person in the photo related to Raj?

- (a) Niece
- (b) Daughter
- (c) Sister
- (d) Mother
- (e) Cousin

Answer: (b) Daughter

Explanation: Only daughter of Raj's mother = Raj himself (in self-referential phrasing). The person's mother = Raj. So the person is Raj's daughter.

QR4. A walks 5 km North, turns right and walks 3 km, then turns right and walks 5 km. How far is he from the start and in which direction?

- (a) 3 km East
- (b) 3 km West
- (c) 8 km East
- (d) 5 km North
- (e) 3 km South

Answer: (a) 3 km East

Explanation: Start(0,0). 5N $\rightarrow$ (0,5). Turn right(East), 3E $\rightarrow$ (3,5). Turn right(South), 5S $\rightarrow$ (3,0). Distance from(0,0)=3 km East.

QR5. Series: 2, 6, 18, 54, ?, 486

- (a) 108
- (b) 162
- (c) 216
- (d) 144
- (e) 200

Answer: (b) 162

Explanation: Pattern $\times 3$: $2 \times 3 = 6$, $6 \times 3 = 18$, $18 \times 3 = 54$, $54 \times 3 = 162$, $162 \times 3 = 486$.

QQ1. $348 + 252 \times 4 \div 12 - 36 = ?$

- (a) 384
- (b) 396
- (c) 408
- (d) 352

(e) 372

Answer: (b) 396

Explanation: BODMAS: $252 \times 4 = 1008$; $1008/12 = 84$; $348 + 84 - 36 = 396$.

QQ2. $2/5$ of 650 + $3/7$ of 490 - 120 = ?

(a) 310

(b) 320

(c) 340

(d) 350

(e) 360

Answer: (d) 350

Explanation: $2/5 \times 650 = 260$; $3/7 \times 490 = 210$; $260 + 210 - 120 = 350$.

QQ3. $15^2 - 12^2 + 8^2 = ?$

(a) 113

(b) 121

(c) 145

(d) 97

(e) 109

Answer: (c) 145

Explanation: $15^2 = 225$; $12^2 = 144$; $8^2 = 64$; $225 - 144 + 64 = 145$.

QQ4. $(1/4 + 1/6 + 1/12) \times 120 = ?$

(a) 50

(b) 55

(c) 60

(d) 65

(e) 45

Answer: (c) 60

Explanation: $1/4 + 1/6 + 1/12 = 3/12 + 2/12 + 1/12 = 6/12 = 1/2$; $(1/2) \times 120 = 60$.

QQ5. $(7/8) \times 640 \div (7/4) = ?$

(a) 80

(b) 160

(c) 240

(d) 320

(e) 400

Answer: (d) 320

Explanation: $7/8 \times 640 = 560$; $560 \div (7/4) = 560 \times (4/7) = 320$.

QQ6. SI on Rs.8,000 at 6% p.a. for 3 years = ?

(a) Rs.1,240

(b) Rs.1,340

(c) Rs.1,400

(d) Rs.1,440

(e) Rs.1,480

Answer: (d) Rs.1,440

Explanation: $SI = PRT/100 = 8000 \times 6 \times 3/100 = \text{Rs.}1440$.

QQ7. CI on Rs.10,000 at 10% p.a. for 2 years (compounded annually) = ?

(a) Rs.2,000

(b) Rs.2,100

(c) Rs.1,900

(d) Rs.2,200

(e) Rs.1,800

Answer: (b) Rs.2,100

Explanation: $CI = P[(1+r)^t - 1] = 10000 \times [(1.10)^2 - 1] = 10000 \times 0.21 = \text{Rs.}2100$.

QQ8. A does work in 12 days, B in 18 days. Working together, they finish in:

(a) 6.2 days

(b) 7.2 days

- (c) 6.8 days
- (d) 8.0 days
- (e) 7.6 days

Answer: (b) 7.2 days

Explanation: Rate=1/12+1/18=5/36; Time=36/5=7.2 days.

QQ9. Train 200 m long passes a pole in 10 seconds. Speed in km/h = ?

- (a) 60
- (b) 66
- (c) 72
- (d) 80
- (e) 54

Answer: (c) 72

Explanation: Speed=200/10=20 m/s=20x18/5=72 km/h.

QQ10. Average of 5 numbers is 40. One is excluded, average becomes 36. Excluded number = ?

- (a) 52
- (b) 54
- (c) 56
- (d) 58
- (e) 60

Answer: (c) 56

Explanation: Sum of 5=200; Sum of 4=144; Excluded=56.

QQ11. CP=Rs.1,200, Profit=25%. SP = ?

- (a) Rs.1,400
- (b) Rs.1,450
- (c) Rs.1,500
- (d) Rs.1,550
- (e) Rs.1,350

Answer: (c) Rs.1,500

Explanation: SP=CP x (100+P%)/100=1200x125/100=Rs.1500.

QQ12. Milk:Water = 4:1. Add 10L water, ratio becomes 4:3. Original total quantity = ?

- (a) 20L
- (b) 25L
- (c) 30L
- (d) 35L
- (e) 40L

Answer: (b) 25L

Explanation: $4x/(x+10)=4/3 \Rightarrow 12x=4x+40 \Rightarrow x=5$. Total=4x+x=25L.

QQ13. Pipe A fills in 6h. Pipe B drains in 10h. Both open: time to fill empty tank?

- (a) 12 hrs
- (b) 15 hrs
- (c) 18 hrs
- (d) 20 hrs
- (e) 24 hrs

Answer: (b) 15 hrs

Explanation: Net fill=1/6-1/10=2/30=1/15 per hr; Time=15 hrs.

QQ14. SP of 10 articles = CP of 12. Profit % = ?

- (a) 15%
- (b) 18%
- (c) 20%
- (d) 22%
- (e) 25%

Answer: (c) 20%

Explanation: Let CP/unit=1. CP10=10, SP10=12, Profit=2, Profit%=20%.

QQ15. A doubles money in 8 years at SI. In how many years will it triple?

- (a) 12
- (b) 14
- (c) 16
- (d) 18
- (e) 20

Answer: (c) 16

Explanation: Rate=100/8=12.5% p.a. To triple: $T=200/12.5=16$ years.

QE1. The bank have (A) / announced a new (B) / loan scheme for (C) / small businesses. (D) / No error (E)

- (a) A
- (b) B
- (c) C
- (d) D
- (e) No error

Answer: (a) A

Explanation: "The bank" is singular. Use "has announced" not "have announced."

QE2. Despite of his best efforts, he could not clear the examination.

- (a) Despite of his best
- (b) efforts he
- (c) could not clear
- (d) the examination
- (e) No error

Answer: (a) Despite of his best

Explanation: "Despite" never takes "of." Correct: "Despite his best efforts."

QE3. Choose the word meaning OPPOSITE to VERBOSE:

- (a) Wordy
- (b) Elaborate
- (c) Concise
- (d) Detailed
- (e) Long-winded

Answer: (c) Concise

Explanation: VERBOSE = using too many words. Antonym = CONCISE (brief and to the point).

QE4. The bank is considering _____ a new mobile app for its customers.

- (a) to launch
- (b) launch
- (c) launched
- (d) launching
- (e) will launch

Answer: (d) launching

Explanation: "Considering" requires a gerund (verb+ing). "Considering launching" is correct.

QE5. He has been working in this bank _____ five years.

- (a) since
- (b) for
- (c) during
- (d) within
- (e) from

Answer: (b) for

Explanation: "For" is used with a period/duration of time. "Since" needs a specific point in time.

QG1. The current Repo Rate (August 2026) is:

- (a) 5.00%
- (b) 5.25%
- (c) 5.50%
- (d) 5.75%
- (e) 6.00%

Answer: (b) 5.25%

Explanation: RBI reduced the Repo Rate to 5.25% in December 2025. Rate at which RBI lends to commercial banks.

QG2. PMSBY (PM Suraksha Bima Yojana) annual premium is:

- (a) Rs.12
- (b) Rs.20
- (c) Rs.30
- (d) Rs.100
- (e) Rs.436

Answer: (b) Rs.20

Explanation: PMSBY = Rs.20/year. Provides Rs.2 lakh accidental death/disability cover. Rs.436 is PMJJBY premium.

QG3. RTGS minimum transaction amount is:

- (a) Rs.50,000
- (b) Rs.1 lakh
- (c) Rs.2 lakh
- (d) Rs.5 lakh
- (e) No minimum

Answer: (c) Rs.2 lakh

Explanation: RTGS is for large-value transfers of Rs.2 lakh and above. No maximum limit. Available 24x7.

QG4. MUDRA Tarun category provides loans up to:

- (a) Rs.50,000
- (b) Rs.5 lakh
- (c) Rs.10 lakh
- (d) Rs.20 lakh
- (e) Rs.25 lakh

Answer: (c) Rs.10 lakh

Explanation: MUDRA: Shishu up to Rs.50,000 | Kishor Rs.50K-Rs.5L | Tarun Rs.5L-Rs.10L.

QG5. UPI (Unified Payments Interface) is operated by:

- (a) RBI
- (b) SEBI
- (c) NPCI
- (d) IRDAI
- (e) PFRDA

Answer: (c) NPCI

Explanation: NPCI (National Payments Corporation of India) developed and operates UPI, RuPay, NEFT, IMPS, FASTag.

QG6. NPA is a loan where payment has not been received for more than:

- (a) 30 days
- (b) 60 days
- (c) 90 days
- (d) 120 days
- (e) 180 days

Answer: (c) 90 days

Explanation: Non-Performing Asset = loan where interest or principal remains overdue for more than 90 days.

QG7. The RBI Governor (as of 2026) is:

- (a) Shaktikanta Das
- (b) Raghuram Rajan
- (c) Urjit Patel
- (d) Sanjay Malhotra
- (e) Duvvuri Subbarao

Answer: (d) Sanjay Malhotra

Explanation: Sanjay Malhotra became the 26th RBI Governor in December 2024, succeeding Shaktikanta Das.

QG8. Which act allows banks to auction mortgaged property without a court order?

- (a) FEMA
- (b) PMLA
- (c) SARFAESI Act
- (d) RBI Act

(e) Banking Regulation Act

Answer: (c) SARFAESI Act

Explanation: SARFAESI Act 2002 empowers banks to recover NPAs by seizing and selling collateral without court intervention.

QG9. Priority Sector Lending target for scheduled commercial banks is:

(a) 30% of ANBC

(b) 35% of ANBC

(c) 40% of ANBC

(d) 45% of ANBC

(e) 50% of ANBC

Answer: (c) 40% of ANBC

Explanation: Banks must lend 40% of Adjusted Net Bank Credit to priority sectors. Agriculture alone requires 18%.

QG10. Canara Bank is headquartered in:

(a) Mumbai

(b) Chennai

(c) Hyderabad

(d) Bengaluru

(e) Kolkata

Answer: (d) Bengaluru

Explanation: Canara Bank is headquartered in Bengaluru, Karnataka. Founded in 1906.

Chapter 8: 58-Day Mains Study Plan + Mock Schedule

26 Sep -> 23 Nov 2026

PHASE 1: 27 SEP - 10 OCT (14 days) — GK Foundation + Advanced Reasoning

After Prelims on 26 Sep, immediately begin Mains prep. Do NOT wait for Prelims result.

Time slot	Activity
Morning (15 min daily)	Oliveboard Daily Quiz app — 10 Banking GK questions. Non-negotiable daily habit.
Evening: Banking GK (45 min)	Study all static GK: RBI rates, scheme details, bank HQs, banking terms A-Z. Use Chapter 6 of this guide.
Evening: Current Affairs (30 min)	Read Adda247 monthly GK capsule. Cover Apr-Oct 2026.
Evening: Reasoning Advanced (45 min)	Complex multi-variable puzzles, Input-Output, Logical Reasoning (Statement-Conclusion).
IBPS Clerk Prelims (10-11 Oct)	Review SBI Prelims performance, correct weak spots, target 75+ in IBPS too.
Total daily study	2.5-3 hours

PHASE 2: 11 OCT - 31 OCT (21 days) — DI Mastery + English Advanced

Activity	Detail
DI sets daily (60 min)	Solve 2 DI sets per day: Table + Bar chart. Progress to Caselet and Pie chart in Week 3.
English advanced (30 min)	Para Summary, Sentence Rearrangement (6 sentences), Double Cloze Test, Word Usage in context.
Banking GK (30 min)	Practice 20 GK questions per day on Oliveboard. Oct-Nov 2026 current affairs.
Full Mains mock (weekly)	One 160-min full Mains mock every Sunday. Analyse all wrong answers.
Total daily	3 hours weekdays, 4.5 hours weekend (including mock)

PHASE 3: 1 NOV - 17 NOV (17 days) — Full Mock Intensive

Activity	Detail
Full Mains mocks (3 per week)	Monday, Wednesday, Friday — 160-min timed full mock. Analyse for 25 min after.
Computer Aptitude (one-time, 30 min)	Review Chapter 5: MS Office shortcuts + number system conversions. Score 20/20.
GK Nov revision	Nov 2026 current affairs daily. All scheme numbers revised from Chapter 6.
English RC speed practice	1 RC passage per day, 3 minutes maximum for all 5 questions.
Score target by Week 7	125-140/200 in each mock. Increase systematically each week.

PHASE 4: 18-22 NOV (5 days) — Final Sprint

Date	Activity
18-19 Nov	Last 2 full mocks. Target 140+ in each. Review your complete error log from all mocks.
20 Nov	GK rapid revision: read all rate tables, scheme numbers, bank HQs once in the morning.
21 Nov	REST DAY. Zero heavy study. Reread Chapter 9 (exam day strategy) once. Sleep by 10 PM.
22 Nov	Half-day rest. Download admit card. Visit exam centre in afternoon. Confirm route. Pack bag.
23 Nov	SBI CLERK MAINS. Target 150+/200. Execute the 160-minute strategy from Chapter 9.

MOCK TEST SCORE PROGRESSION TRACKER

Mock / Date	Target Score	Focus for that phase
Mock 1 (27 Sep)	65-80 / 200	Baseline diagnostic. Identify 3 weakest topics.
Mock 2 (4 Oct)	75-90 / 200	Fix careless errors. Establish GK daily routine.
Mock 3 (11 Oct)	85-100 / 200	Computer Aptitude = 18+. DI: solve 2 sets fully.
Mock 4 (18 Oct)	95-110 / 200	Reasoning: 3 puzzle sets cracked. English: 24+.
Mock 5 (25 Oct)	105-120 / 200	GK: 30+. Approximation technique for all DI.
Mock 6 (1 Nov)	115-130 / 200	All sections above sectional cutoff. Computer 20/20.
Mock 7 (8 Nov)	125-140 / 200	GK: 35+. DI: 3 sets solved. English: 28+.
Mock 8 (15 Nov)	135-150 / 200	Full speed. No wasted time. All tactics locked in.
Mock 9 (19 Nov)	140-155 / 200	Final calibration. No new topics. Pure execution.
MAINS (23 Nov)	150+ / 200	TOP RANK. Best Mumbai posting. Best career start.

Chapter 9: Exam Hall Strategy + Documents Checklist

Prelims: 26 Sep |
Mains: 23 Nov

PRELIMS — 60-MINUTE STRATEGY

Sections are time-LOCKED at 20 min each. You cannot go back or skip ahead. Use every second of each section within that section.

Reasoning (0:00 - 20:00 min)

0:00-0:30: Scan all 35 Q, tag easy vs hard

0:30-8:00: Solve 2 easiest puzzle sets (linear/circular seating, 5 Q each)

8:00-14:00: Syllogism (all 5 Q) + Inequality (all Q) + Coding-Decoding

14:00-18:00: Blood Relations + Direction Sense + Alphanumeric Series

18:00-20:00: Attempt any remaining easy Q. Skip hard 3-variable puzzles.

Target: 26+/35 correct

Numerical Ability (20:00 - 40:00 min)

20:00-30:00: ALL Simplification/Approximation Q (10-15 Q) — fastest marks

30:00-34:00: Number Series (5 Q) — 30 sec each, skip if not clear

34:00-38:00: Easy Arithmetic Q (%, ratio, average)

38:00-40:00: DI set — table or bar chart type (5 Q)

Target: 24+/35 correct

English Language (40:00 - 60:00 min)

40:00-46:00: Fill in blanks + Error Detection + Word Replacement (fastest)

46:00-52:00: Cloze Test (read paragraph once, fill blanks)

52:00-57:00: Para Jumbles (find opener, find conclusion, link middle)

57:00-60:00: RC — vocabulary + direct fact Q only. Skip inference Q.

Target: 20+/30 correct

MAINS — 160-MINUTE OPTIMAL SEQUENCE

Mains has NO locked sections — you can move between sections freely. Use this to your advantage.

Time	Section	Strategy
0-8 min	Computer Aptitude (10 Q)	Score 18-20 marks immediately. Builds confidence. FREE marks for B.E. CS.
8-20 min	Easy Reasoning (Syllogism + Inequality)	~10 Q, all correct. Quick marks before puzzles.
20-40 min	Reasoning Puzzles (3 sets x 5 Q)	Carefully solve 3 puzzle sets. Skip very hard sets. Target 15+ marks.
40-75 min	GK/Financial Awareness (all 50 Q)	No calculation — pure memory. Attempt all, skip if zero idea.
75-100 min	DI sets (Table + Bar + one more)	Solve 3 DI sets = 15 Q. Use approximation. Skip caselet if slow.
100-130 min	English (Fill -> Error -> Cloze -> RC)	In order: fastest to slowest topics.

Time	Section	Strategy
130-150 min	Remaining Quant arithmetic Q	Easy arithmetic word problems. Skip complex ones.
150-160 min	Review & attempt remaining Q	Return to marked questions. Fill only if >70% confident.

NEGATIVE MARKING RULES — WHEN TO ATTEMPT vs SKIP

GOLDEN RULE: Attempt only if you are **MORE THAN 70% confident**. In 50-50 situations, the expected score is **-0.125 per Q** — not worth it.

Question type	Attempt when	Skip when
Simplification/Approximation	ALWAYS attempt — you should know the answer from BODMAS	Skip only if two options are very close
Syllogism/Inequality	ALWAYS attempt — rule-based, very reliable	Skip if statement has 3+ premises and you are unsure
Number Series	Attempt if pattern clear within 30 seconds	Skip if pattern unclear after 30 sec — return later
DI questions	Attempt all Q from a set you have solved completely	Do not partially attempt a DI set — do all or none
Banking GK	Attempt if you know the answer confidently	Skip if you genuinely do not know — do not guess between 2 similar options
RC inference Q	Attempt if passage context is clear	Skip "author's purpose/tone" Q — too risky

DAY BEFORE PRELIMS (25 Sep) AND DAY BEFORE MAINS (22 Nov)

NO FULL MOCK the day before either exam. Light revision only — 30 min maximum.

Item	What to do
Study	Reread Chapter 6 GK tables (rates, scheme numbers, bank HQs) — 30 min maximum
Exam centre	Visit the exam centre in afternoon. Confirm gate entrance, parking, travel time by your mode.
Documents	Pack bag tonight: 2 printed admit cards + Aadhaar original + 2 passport photos
Food	Light dinner. No oily, heavy, or new/unfamiliar food the night before.
Sleep	Strictly in bed by 10:00 PM. Set 2 alarms (5:00 AM + 5:15 AM).
Clothes + bag	Lay out your clothes and packed bag the night before. No last-minute scramble.

EXAM DAY MORNING

Action	Details
Wake up	5:00 AM — 90+ minutes before reporting time
Breakfast	Light breakfast: idli/upma/bread+egg. Nothing heavy. Carry water.
Travel	Leave with 45 min buffer for Mumbai traffic. Arrive 40 min before exam.
At centre	Biometric + photo verification takes 15-20 min. Arrive early.
Mindset	Take 3 deep breaths before exam starts. You have prepared well.
During exam	If one section goes badly: RESET mentally. Focus only on the current section.

Action	Details
After exam	Do NOT discuss answers outside hall. Different exam shifts have different papers.

DOCUMENTS CHECKLIST — CARRY TO PRELIMS & MAINS

Document	Details
Printed admit card	2 copies — downloaded from sbi.bank.in (~20 Sep for Prelims)
Original Aadhaar card	Same ID that was used during SBI form registration. NOT a photocopy.
Passport-size photographs	2 photographs (same as uploaded in application form)
STRICTLY PROHIBITED	Mobile phone, smartwatch, Bluetooth earphones, calculator, any paper notes

DOCUMENTS FOR DOCUMENT VERIFICATION (after Mains selection)

Bring these documents in ORIGINAL + 2 sets of photocopies to Document Verification:

OBC-NCL certificate (Non-Creamy Layer) — issued within 1 year of application date

Caste Certificate (Hindu Kunbi, OBC)

Caste Validity Certificate

B.E. Degree Certificate / Provisional Certificate (Rizvi College, Mumbai University)

All semester marksheets of B.E. (2016-2020)

Class 12 (HSC) marksheet + passing certificate

Class 10 (SSC) marksheet + passing certificate

Aadhaar card

PAN card

Domicile certificate (Maharashtra)

6-8 passport-size photographs

Birth certificate or DOB proof

Experience letter from eScan MicroWorld Software Services Pvt. Ltd.

Bank account details (for salary credit)

Medical fitness certificate (from Civil/Government Hospital Surgeon)

YOUR B.E. CS DEGREE IS A KEY DOCUMENT at SBI DV — it directly proves eligibility and also signals to the bank your Computer knowledge advantage for internal promotions to SO (Specialist Officer - IT) track.

SBI CLERK SALARY & CAREER GROWTH

Component	Amount / Detail
Basic Pay (starting)	Rs.26,730 per month
Dearness Allowance (DA ~38%)	Rs.10,157 per month (revised quarterly)
Special Allowance (25.12%)	Rs.6,714 per month
HRA — Mumbai (Metro)	Rs.3,500-4,000 per month
City Compensatory Allowance	Rs.1,600 per month
Transport Allowance	Rs.1,000 per month
Gross Monthly (Mumbai)	Rs.44,000 - 50,000 per month

Component	Amount / Detail
Take-home after deductions	Rs.38,000 - 44,000 per month
CTC (with all benefits)	Rs.6 - 7.5 LPA
Medical/Housing Loan benefit	Concessional home loan ~6.7% vs market 8.5%+
Promotion to Officer (JMGS-I)	2-3 years via internal exam (easier for CS background)
After promotion salary	Rs.60,000 - 75,000 per month gross
SBI IT/Cyber Security Track	Your B.E. CS + eScan = fast-track to SBI YONO/Cyber security division post-promotion

Mains: 23 Nov 2026 | Target: 150+ / 200 | Top rank in Maharashtra OBC

Computer Aptitude (20 marks) = FREE for B.E. CS

GK (50 marks) = 15 minutes daily = 38+ marks

OBC-NCL cutoff = ~70/200 — your target of 150 is 2x the cutoff

You have the education, the experience, and the preparation.

Now execute the plan. Good luck.